

Simone van Buuren

📍 Lisboa, Portugal 📧 van.buuren.simone@proton.me 📞 (+351)920146584 📺 in/simone-van-buuren 🐙 github.com/svbygoibear

ABOUT ME

I'm a Staff Engineer specialising in large-scale distributed web applications and services, with 4+ years of experience leading developer teams — both technically and as a bridge between technical and non-technical stakeholders. I thrive in cross-functional, product-focused environments.

My career has spanned a wide range of domains and technical challenges, which has made me comfortable picking up new tools and contexts quickly. I'm currently fluent in C#, SQL, Go, and React, and have worked extensively with Kotlin, Java, Scala, Python, Node.js, various JS frameworks, and Docker — with a few scars from PHP and CoffeeScript along the way. I pay close attention to detail and genuinely enjoy learning.

I'm a South African based in Portugal since 2023, working fully remotely — as I have since 2019, and with distributed teams since the start of my career. I'm happy to travel for work, and enjoy contributing to the community; I'm currently a co-organiser of DevOps Lisbon and happy to present at conferences.

EXPERIENCE

STAFF ENGINEER

PLEO

September 2025 - April 2026, REMOTE, LISBON, PORTUGAL

- Lead the core Credit team within Pleo's Cash Management & Treasury vertical, driving performance and architectural improvements to scale spend controls and credit infrastructure for 1000x growth in usage and transactions — redesigning core systems using DDD and event-driven architecture.
- Drove the company-wide adoption of Temporal as the golden-path workflow engine for complex, long-running tasks, leading cross-domain migration away from JobRunr while managing security and procurement requirements — reducing operational effort by over 54% and cutting costs across development, maintenance, and observability.
- Improved cross-team collaboration by redesigning onboarding for incidents and monitoring into a self-service experience, reducing ramp-up time from a week-long partnership session to a single day.
- Architected an E2E testing framework for backend-exclusive and internal systems, championing its adoption across the vertical and co-facilitating a Backend Testing Community of Practice to standardise testing guidelines company-wide — contributing to a 20%+ reduction in incidents.
- Serve on Pleo's company-wide Architecture Board alongside other Staff+ engineers, stewarding architectural decisions and producing ADRs covering API security, saga pattern implementations, Temporal adoption, and incident management practices for all teams and individual contributors.

TECHNICAL LEAD

QORUSDOCS

April 2021 - August 2025, REMOTE, LISBON, PORTUGAL

- Contributing hands-on to the product & leading development of high-performance, scalable, secure, customer facing features & APIs with various stakeholders (including leadership) primarily using React, Typescript, Docker, C# & .NET Core, MS SQL Server, Datadog and Azure ensure yearly targets exceed 100% met. This includes a mix of micro-services & a monolith system.
 - Technical Lead on the development of AI-driven QPilot feature which increased user adoption by 45% and reduced proposal creation time by 60% & resulted in 3 new product offerings. This resulted in an increase in ARR as well as new clients to exceed targets 3 quarters in a row.
 - Responsible for onboarding, mentoring new and fellow engineers & managing internal developer documentation and guides.
 - Owned our messaging, testing and CI/CD pipelines as part of our internal developer experience to own what is built & contributed to an internal worker in Golang that automates part of our developer board and bug response system. This has been implemented across all environments including production and staging.
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SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

QORUSDOCS

November 2018 - March 2021, CAPE TOWN, SOUTH AFRICA

- Proficiency in developing product features & automated tests with React, C#, .NET Core, Entity Framework, MS SQL Server, CosmosDB as well as fixing bugs and resolving blockers or issues customers may face.
- Create proof of concept for new technologies and features and collaborate with our internal product and design team to iterate and refine upcoming features, reducing design and grooming time by 25% on average.
- Investigate and resolve critical system issues with 98% success rate alongside developing a feedback system for tightening SLA timelines.
- Streamlined development workflow by introducing CI/CD practices, reducing deployment times from more than an hour to minutes.

SOFTWARE ENGINEER

SPAN DIGITAL INNOVATION

January 2017 - October 2018, CAPE TOWN, SOUTH AFRICA

- Developed multi-platform streaming applications with payment integration for our major streaming client, BamTech, as well as creating the SDK and ADK for all their other React-based applications used by more than 10 teams.
- Collaborated as a key member of the consulting team to completely rewrite a content-monetization platform's core product from PHP to Golang, helping establish engineering standards and develop boilerplate code foundations that enabled three internal teams to contribute to a shared codebase, increasing cross-team collaboration from effectively 0% to over 60%.
- Developed internal tooling using Scala micro-services and AWS following the onion-architecture pattern.

SOFTWARE DEVELOPER

FULL FACING

March 2016 - January 2017, CAPE TOWN, SOUTH AFRICA

- Responsible for an IoT internal integration into a system called iFings to create a workflow for the grocery pre-packaged food industry to increase food safety around hot foods, processing data from over 50 devices streaming every second at any given moment.
- Reworked an existing eLearning platform called Lessondesk as part of moving the system to a cloud-based architecture.
- Contributed to DX internally by creating automated documentation tooling and microservice ADKs to help boost developer productivity and increase client focussed output, increasing sprint velocity by 18%.

SYSTEMS ANALYST AND DEVELOPER

SYBRIN LIMITED

December 2014 - February 2016, JOHANNESBURG, SOUTH AFRICA

- Developed workflow processing and granular case history tools, improving client turnaround on KYC at a minimum of 20% per case.
- Created web APIs using C#, ASP.NET, WCF geared at internal wealth management portfolios, contributing to the national paperless initiative.
- Responsible for query fine tuning, resulting in an overall reduction to hardware requirements for our on-premises software. One notable query improvement ensured processing from 8 seconds to less than 2 seconds.

EDUCATION

I have a BComp Hons in Computer Science from [Belgium Campus](#). I graduated third in my class in 2015 with an overall average of 71.1% and with Cum Laude. For my final year project I opted for a team-focussed project where we developed a monitoring system for solar farms and solar panels in remote areas of Africa. I worked on part of the system that used SMS to send data to a central device which would in turn package it for a HTTPS request later using a small Arduino device with a GSM Shield. I also update my yearly AZ204 Certificate.

COMPUTER SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT HONOURS

Belgium Campus • Pretoria, South Africa • 01/2015 - 12/2015

COMPUTER SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT AND ENGINEERING

Belgium Campus • Pretoria, South Africa • 01/2012 - 12/2014

[AZURE DEVELOPER ASSOCIATE \(AZ 204\)](#)

Microsoft • 07/2021 – 07/2026

SKILLS

LEADERSHIP SKILLS

- Give technical talks and training internally as part of mentoring.
- Responsible for reviewing code, pair programming and developing engineering practices with my team; both in person and remote.
- Work across engineering and product teams to plan and design features as well as solve hard problems.
- Deliver proof-of-concept work on new technologies, new technical designs or to sample test new features before development.

SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT

- Developed backend and frontend web systems and services in scalable, async distributed systems as well as internal tooling. I have worked on different databases, monoliths and micro-services, APIs (RESTful and not) and even external ADKs.
- Debugged asynchronous and distributed production systems using metrics, traces and logs (no stranger to observability) as well as coordinate real-time with clients facing issues.
- I'm no stranger to DevOps; creating Docker images, build & deploy pipelines or even spinning up new services is in my wheelhouse. I've also worked in automation of this and contributed to internal CI/CD pipelines.
- Developed internal ways of working, optimised by removing or adapting processes within teams where needed and even created some SDKs and ADKs used by teams across the internal organization.

NON-EXHAUSTIVE LIST OF TOOLS

.NET / .NET Core / .NET Framework, Go/Golang, Node.js, React.js, Angular, Vuejs, Scala, Kotlin, Java, Python, Azure and AWS, Azure DevOps & GitHub, Git, SQL, Database Technologies (My SQL, DynamoDB, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, MS SQL Server), RabbitMQ, PubSub, Kafka, SQS, Docker, Distributed Systems, AI Integrations, Vitetest, JMeter, Unit Testing (xUnit), Storybook (UI component testing), Jest, Monitoring Tools (ie DataDog, ELK, Grafana), MySQL, SendGrid, Twilio, GitHub, PostCSS, SSG, Web Security, Vercel, DropWizard, Gradle, SpringBoot